DETACHMENT — HORUS HERESY (30K)

SELFLESS BURDEN

SALAMANDERS (HH, LOYALIST) | WARHAMMER 40,000 | 11TH EDITION

Selfless Burden is a fully homebrew Detachment for the Salamanders (XVIII Legion) faction — a Horus Heresy-era Loyalist Legion detachment adapted to the Warhammer 40,000 11th-edition Detachment framework, built from the real HH3e Salamanders Rite of War data. Formatted to match the No Figure Left Behind Combat Patrol archive.

FACTION ABILITY

PROMETHEAN ENDURANCE & BLOOD OF FIRE
The forge tempers what fire cannot break. Each time an attack targets a friendly Salamanders unit, that attack's Wound roll cannot succeed on an unmodified roll of 1 or 2. In addition, friendly Salamanders units are unaffected by the Battle-shock tests triggered by attacks made by Flamer-type weapons.

DETACHMENT RULE

Detachment Points: To use this detachment you must spend 1 DP.

SELFLESS BURDEN
There is always one more of them willing to be the wall. Once per battle, when an enemy unit declares a charge that targets a friendly Salamanders unit (excluding Vehicles), you can select that unit: until the end of the Fight phase, improve the Weapon Skill characteristic of melee weapons equipped by models in that unit by 1, and add 1 to the Attacks and Strength characteristics of those weapons. Then, for each model in that unit that fights this phase, roll one D6: on a 1, that model's unit suffers 1 mortal wound.

FORCE DISPOSITIONS
This detachment has access to the following Force Disposition: Purge the Foe.

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

Included: All homebrew Salamanders (HH) roster units (Vulkan, Cassian Dracos Reborn, Adherents Squad, Firedrake Terminator Squad, Pyroclast Squad, Sanctifier Squad, Inductii Squad), and any homebrew Legiones Astartes (HH) unit from the generic Space Marines (HH) roster given the Salamanders Trait.

Excluded: Any other Legion's Primarch or named characters. Non-Legiones-Astartes allies, per standard HH3e Legion-purity convention.

ENHANCEMENTS

DRAKENSCALE ARMOUR — *Character model only*
Each time a wound is allocated to the bearer from an attack made by a Flamer, Melta, Plasma, or Volkite weapon, that attack's Damage characteristic is treated as being 1.

RELIC OF THE FORGE — *Character model only*
Each time the bearer fights, that model's melee weapons have the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability.

STANDARD OF NOCTURNE — *Character model only*
While the bearer is leading a unit, each time a model in that unit is destroyed, roll one D6: on a 6, that model is not destroyed and instead is returned to the unit with 1 wound remaining.

UNYIELDING PROMETHEAN — *Character model only*
Each time the bearer's unit takes a Battle-shock test, that test is automatically passed.

STRATAGEMS

DUTY IS SACRIFICE **1CP**
Salamanders — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Fight phase or Shooting phase, just before a friendly Salamanders Character model is chosen to fight or shoot.

Target: That model.

Effect: Select a number from 1-3. That model suffers that many mortal wounds. Until the end of the phase, add that number to Hit rolls for that model's attacks.

FORGE ANEW **1CP**
Salamanders — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Command phase.

Target: One friendly Salamanders unit.

Effect: Until your next Command phase, that unit is not Battle-shocked while it is below its Starting Strength.

CLEANSING FLAME **1CP**
Salamanders — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Your Shooting phase, just before a friendly Salamanders unit shoots.

Target: That unit.

Effect: Until the end of the phase, ranged weapons equipped by models in that unit that have the [TORRENT] ability have the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability.

MERCILESS RETALIATION **1CP**
Salamanders — Epic Deed Stratagem

When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Salamanders unit is destroyed.

Target: The enemy unit that destroyed it.

Effect: That enemy unit suffers 3 mortal wounds.

GRIM DETERMINATION **2CP**
Salamanders — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Command phase.

Target: One friendly Salamanders unit.

Effect: Until your next Command phase, each time a model in that unit makes an attack, an unmodified Wound roll of 1 or 2 still fails, but a Critical Wound is scored on an unmodified Wound roll of 5+ (instead of 6+).

SALVAGE THE FALLEN **2CP**
Salamanders — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Your Shooting phase, just after a friendly Salamanders Vehicle unit is selected to shoot.

Target: That unit.

Effect: Until the end of the phase, ranged weapons equipped by models in that unit have the [LETHAL HITS] ability.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — HH3e (2026) Salamanders Legion Rite of War → 11e conversion. Built from the real HH3e Rite of War data in `Salamanders.json`, which has one baseline rite with three named pieces. The real Legion Tactica bundles two distinct Special Rules — Promethean Endurance (Wound Tests against Salamanders auto-fail on an unmodified 1 or 2) and Blood of Fire (immunity to Panic checks from Flame-Trait weapons) — both translated directly and combined into a single Faction Ability, matching how the real data itself presents them as one package. Gambit "Duty is Sacrifice" (real: suffer a scaling number of automatic wounds in exchange for the same bonus to a Focus Roll) became the identically-named Stratagem, translated as a self-inflicted mortal wound cost for a Hit-roll bonus, preserving the real risk/reward trade directly. Advanced Reaction "Selfless Burden" (real: once per battle, a charged pure-Salamanders non-Vehicle unit gains +1 WS/S/A until the end of the Assault Phase, but each model risks 1 automatic wound on a D6 roll of 1) was promoted to the Detachment Rule itself, matching how every other Legion's flagship real mechanic has anchored its own detachment — and a fitting flagship for a Legion whose entire doctrine is stepping forward to take the blow meant for someone else. Forge Anew, Cleansing Flame, Merciless Retaliation, Grim Determination, and Salvage the Fallen are original stratagems filling out the standard six; Enhancements are original, themed around the Legion's fire-resistant, self-sacrificing, and forge-born identity.